

model for port-led city development and rightly so, the theme for the 10th edition of the Vibrant Summit is set as "Gateway to the Future."

He highlighted that Gujarat, with its extensive 1600-kilometre coastline, holds the distinction of having the country's longest coastal stretch. He underscored the strategic initiatives undertaken by the state government, under the guidance of the Prime Minister, will transform Gujarat's coastline into a key gateway for national prosperity. The state is actively involved in the concurrent expansion and enhancement of existing ports, along with the establishment of new port cities and greenfield ports.

Highlighting that Gujarat has more than 49 ports including both major and minor, the Chief Minister pointed out that these ports handle around 39% of the country's cargo. Gujarat's robust road connectivity and maritime development contribute to its high ranking in the Logistics Ease Across Different States (LEADS) index.

He highlighted Gujarat's achievement as the fifth most urbanized state, emphasizing significant milestones in urban development. The Chief Minister stressed the importance of fostering a vibrant economy through sustainable infrastructure in cities near ports, aligning with the Prime Minister's vision. He ensured the state's commitment to port-led city development under the guidance of the Prime Minister.

Speaking about INS Vikrant ship as a prime example of 'Amanirbhar Bharat,' Union Minister of Ports, Shipping and Waterways, Shri Sarbananda Sonowal noted India's substantial growth in the global maritime space and emphasized the importance of port-led industrialization. He outlined that increased traffic would drive trade, creating new employment opportunities. He also presented the vision of the 'Sagarmala project @2035,' highlighting the shift towards green ports and the transformation of various ports into hydrogen hubs.

Mr Keith Svendsen, CEO at APM Terminals, expressed honour in being a part of the Vibrant Gujarat Global Summit, focusing on port-led sector development. He lauded the shipping sector's hyper-efficiency and stressed the importance of infrastructure development for port-led city growth.

H.E. Ms. Marisa Gerards, Ambassador of the Netherlands to India, Bhutan, and Nepal described the Netherlands and India-Gujarat as natural partners and highlighted the role of their vast coastlines in bilateral development. She noted the importance of direct investment in the maritime sector, expecting it to boost industrial activity and create employment opportunities. The Netherlands has signed an MoU in this direction with India and expressed willingness for further collaboration.

Chief Principal Secretary to the Chief Minister, Shri K. Kailasanathan spoke about

the strategic significance of Gujarat's geographical location, being closest to the countries of the Middle East, Africa, and Europe. He advocated for an expansion of the port policy, citing the enormous potential that Gujarat holds.

Speaking on industrial development, Chief Secretary Shri Rajkumar said that Gujarat has the distinction of having the longest coastline of 1600 km and 49 ports, the most active ports in the country. Gujarat stands out as a leader in marine activities, managing approximately 3% of the global economy.

Additional Chief Secretary, of Ports and Transport Mr M.K. Das stated, "Our economy has grown about 7.5 times in the last 21 years. There is no doubt that the way we are developing, I believe we will become a US\$ 30 trillion economy by the year 2047. We have to expand the service area beyond India."

The seminar was attended by Mr. Rajkumar Beniwal, Vice Chairman and CEO at Gujarat Maritime Board, Shri S.S. Rathore, Advisor to the Chief Minister, Mr. Mihir Shah, Partner at EY, Chairman of Deendayal Port Authority Mr. S.K. Mehta, and CEO of APM Terminal Mr. Jonathan Goldner, participated in a panel discussion where various ideas were presented. During the seminar, the Vision-2047 document book was also released by the Chief Minister.

